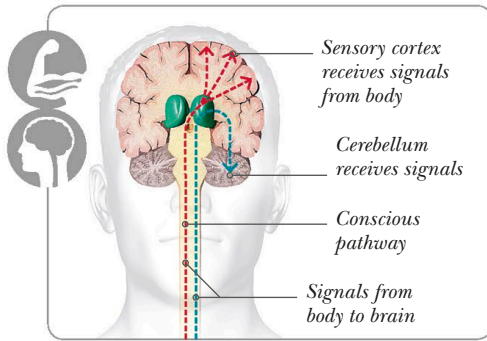




Proprioception

Proprioception is body awareness, particularly while moving through space. Your cerebellum constantly receives unconscious signals from your body about its position, while your cerebral cortex consciously deciphers where you are in space. Mindfully flowing between poses can help develop this awareness and improve balance.

Eyes open or closed

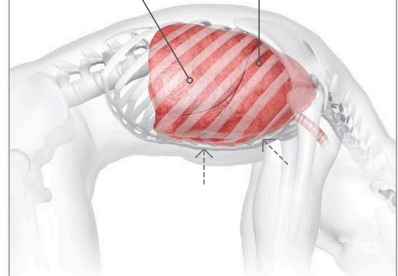
Inhalation and exhalation

Breathe mindfully, coordinating your breath and movement; your nervous system loves this sort of integration. As a general rule, exhale when your ribcage is compressed (as in forward folds or twists), and inhale when your ribcage can expand (as in backbends).



Exhale, compressing your ribcage to push air out

Lungs



EXHALE DURING CAT

Inhale, making space for air to come into your lungs



INHALE DURING COW

Pectoral muscles stabilize your shoulders

Wrists are extended

Kneecap may need padding, such as a folded blanket

ANTERIOR-LATERAL VIEW OF COW